

Cancer Antigen (CA) 15-3

Test Details

METHODOLOGY

Electrochemiluminescence immunoassay (ECLIA)

RESULT TURNAROUND TIME

Within 1 day

Turnaround time is defined as the usual number of days from the date of pickup of a specimen for testing to when the result is released to the ordering provider. In some cases, additional time should be allowed for additional confirmatory or additional reflex tests. Testing schedules may vary.

Use

Quantitative measurement of cancer antigen 15-3

Special Instructions

Values obtained with different assay methods should not be used interchangeably in serial testing. It is recommended that only one assay method be used consistently to monitor each patient's course of therapy. This procedure does not provide serial monitoring; it is intended for one-time use only. If serial monitoring is required, please use the serial monitoring number **483404** (/tests/483404/cancer-antigen-ca-15-3-serial-monitor) to order.

This test may exhibit interference when sample is collected from a person who is consuming a supplement with a high dose of biotin (also termed as vitamin B7 or B8, vitamin H, or coenzyme R). It is recommended to ask all patients who may be indicated for this test about biotin supplementation. Patients should be cautioned to stop biotin consumption at least 72 hours prior to the collection of a sample.

Limitations

The CA 15-3 assay value, regardless of level, should not be interpreted as absolute evidence for the presence or absence of malignant disease. The CA 15-3 assay value should be used in conjunction with information available from clinical evaluation and diagnostic procedure.

Specimen Requirements

Specimen

Serum

Volume

1 mL

Minimum Volume

0.7 mL (**Note:** This volume does **not** allow for repeat testing.)

Container

Gel-barrier tube (preferred) or red-top tube

Collection Instructions

If a red-top tube is used, transfer separated serum to a plastic transport tube.

Stability Requirements

Temperature	Period
Room temperature	14 days
Refrigerated	14 days
Frozen	14 days
Freeze/thaw cycles	Stable x3

Reference Range

0.0–25.0 units/mL

Storage Instructions

Room temperature

Causes for Rejection

Citrate plasma specimen; improper labeling

References

Hayes DF, Zurawski VR Jr, Kufe DW, “Comparison of Circulating CA 15-3 and Carcinoembryonic Antigen Levels in Patients With Breast Cancer,” *J Clin Oncol*, 1986, 4(10):1542-50. PubMed 2428949

(<http://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pubmed/2428949>)